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Digital Product Design + UX Strategy

Selected work for the Product Designer role at Whatnot

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Foreword and table of contents

This portfolio was assembled for the Product Designer role at Whatnot. By design, it prioritizes substance over flash — user experience and product design happen throughout the project cycle, and strategic decisions are embedded in each deliverable.

Many of the strongest UX solutions are hidden in the details, or quietly doing their job behind the curtain. Everything here is the result of close collaboration with my team, the audience, and our clients.

For each project I briefly explain the challenge, what we did to address it, and why it matters. I'd gladly tell you more or answer any questions you might have.

The through-line I'd point you to: systems thinking, zero-to-one problem-solving in ambiguous spaces, and a deep commitment to accessible, inclusive design.

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SECTION 01

User interface and interaction design

Good interface design is mostly invisible — people find what they need without thinking about it. These projects share a thread: complex systems, wide audiences, and design systems built so a small team can ship consistently at scale.

Office of Disease Prevention and Health Promotion

Les Turner ALS Foundation — Interactive decision aid tools

Office of Disease Prevention and Health Promotion

Client: ODPHP

UX research

UI design

Design systems

Information architecture

The challenge

ODPHP's online presence spans several websites that are diverse in purpose and serve a wide range of people. At the same time, it's important there's continuity in the user experience.

What we did

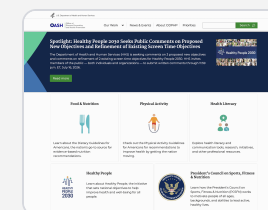
I've served as UX lead on all of the ODPHP properties — involved end to end in research, UX/UI design, prototyping, UX writing, and information architecture. We designed and developed design systems and Drupal CMS environments for each website while assuring consistency and coherence across all of ODPHP.

Why it matters

We increased adoption, retention, and engagement across all of ODPHP's digital properties while improving usability and accessibility — serving millions of people.

3.5M+

Healthy People 2030 pageviews per quarter — up from ~500K (FY19→FY23)



Les Turner ALS Foundation — Interactive decision aid tools

- Client: Les Turner ALS Foundation
- Interaction design
- User flows
- Visual design

The challenge

ALS patients and caregivers face tremendous challenges — a lot of information to process and many hard decisions to make, with each patient at a different stage of their journey. The foundation wanted a way to help patients learn about their options and make informed decisions.

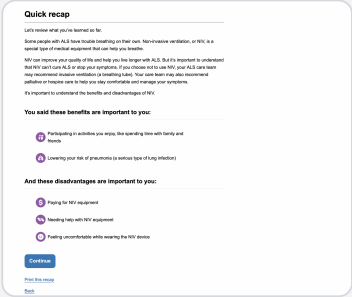
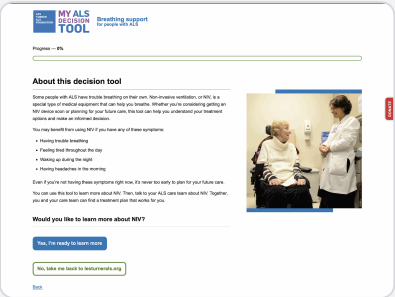
What we did

In close collaboration with people living with ALS, caregivers, researchers, and clinicians, we created a suite of interactive decision-aid tools that communicate complex health information in an accessible, easy-to-understand way. I was responsible for interaction design, user flows, and most of the visual design — including custom iconography for complex ideas — ensuring usability and accessibility at various stages of the ALS journey.

Why it matters

We hear over and over how much of a difference these tools make in the lives of ALS patients and caregivers. They continue to be celebrated by industry professionals and ALS experts. Designing tools that make lives a little better — even when 'better' means 'less hard' — is exactly my professional mission.

2022 ClearMark Award — Best app



SECTION 02

Mobile app design

Some interactions call for a native app — designed for speed, clarity, and real-world pressure. Whatnot's live, real-time moments demand the same: interfaces that stay usable when both the stakes and the pace are high.

Show Me for Emergencies — Massachusetts Department of Public Health

Show Me for Emergencies

Client: Massachusetts Department of Public Health

Information architecture

Taxonomy

Iconography

Mobile app design

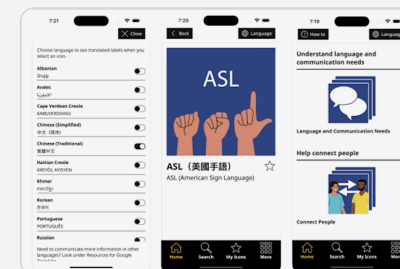
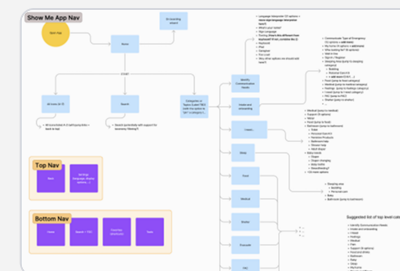
The challenge

The Show Me for Emergencies apps help public-health and emergency workers communicate with people who have difficulty hearing, speaking, or understanding information in emergency settings. Supporting 13 languages and a wide variety of situations, the apps needed a UX/UI refresh for usability, accessibility, and inclusivity.

What we did

I always insist we start with formative research. We ran a usability review of the existing apps and talked to real-world users, which led us to consolidate two apps into one. We overhauled the information architecture and navigation, and I proposed multi-homed communication cards in a poly-hierarchy — taxonomies built for maximal flexibility and future-proofing so the same card can surface in many places and mental models.

We added languages and new translation cards and redesigned the iconography for a friendlier look and feel, applying best practices for people with cognitive disabilities or communication challenges throughout.



Show Me for Emergencies (continued)

Why it matters

Usability testing showed the redesign was universally appreciated, and it met a wide range of communication needs. The work expanded the app's reach across languages and situations and improved accessibility and representation — with special attention to cognitive disability — while simplifying navigation and improving usability under stress.

2025 ClearMark Award — Best app

This is really great — I appreciate how you made this work for a variety of people in all kinds of situations. Your idea to implement taxonomies was key to making it flexible and efficient.

— Mass DPH product owner

SECTION 03

Data visualization

Data is only useful if people can interpret it. I like making hundreds of thousands of data points feel approachable — turning complex, technical information into something anyone can read, slice, and act on.

Healthy People 2030 — Data display

Healthy People 2030 — Data display

Client: ODPHP + NCHS

Data visualization

UI design

Interaction design

Accessibility

The challenge

With over 500 objectives and tens of thousands of associated data points, the UI and interaction design of Healthy People 2030's data display was a big, fun challenge. The data are complex and broad in scope, the audiences diverse, and the visualizations need to be user-friendly across a wide variety of devices and technologies.

What we did

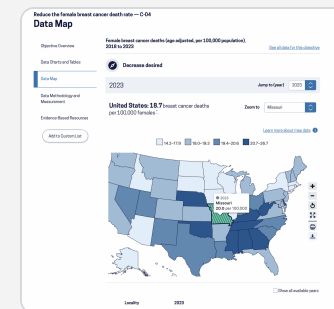
Working closely with ODPHP and NCHS, I created a fully integrated data-visualization tool that lets charts, tables, and maps be customized and filtered based on specific user needs. The visualizations integrate with all 500+ objectives, moving intuitively from a high level down to increasing levels of detail, and we built a user-friendly way to find and interpret disparities data.

Why it matters

Compared to Healthy People 2020, we added functionality while improving discoverability and ease of use. I optimized the interface for both efficiency and simplicity — making the vast amount of data more usable and useful, and greatly increasing adoption and engagement.

16.2M

pageviews in FY2024, up from 14.9M the prior year



Being able to visualize that data, and give people the ability to choose how they want to see it — how they want to slice and dice and manipulate it.

— Usability research participant

SECTION 04

Information architecture and content strategy

Structure is a design material. Taxonomies, poly-hierarchies, and content models are what make complex information flexible, findable, and future-proof — the same foundations a marketplace needs to help people discover the things they love across hundreds of categories.

CDC — Contraceptive Decision Making app

U.S. National Water Safety Action Plan

CDC — Contraceptive Decision Making app

Client: CDC Foundation

Information architecture

Taxonomy

Content strategy

Interaction design

The challenge

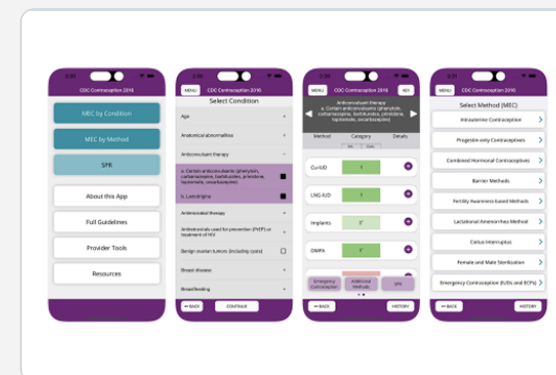
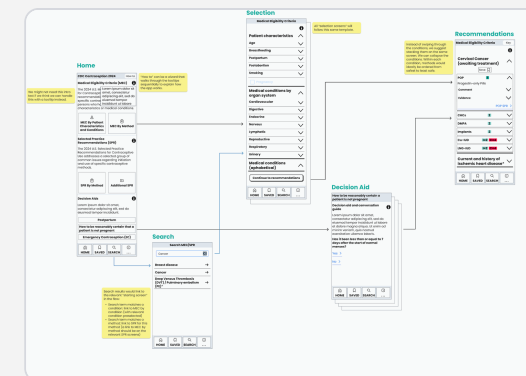
The CDC Contraceptive Decision Making app helps providers explain contraceptive options and limitations, walking providers and patients through decision-making for a variety of methods. The underlying science and the multitude of parameters make the information both complex and technical.

What we did

I conceptualized a multi-faceted, modular system that breaks the content into smaller, interconnected pieces. A combination of logic, taxonomies, and UI/IXD features lets the app support a wide variety of situations, mental models, and preferences.

Why it matters

Contraceptive decisions are highly individualized and personal — the tool had to be flexible enough to account for that without losing detail or nuance in translation. The logic, taxonomies, and content strategy support a conversational flow, so the provider can stay in the moment with the patient while exploring every option and consideration.



U.S. National Water Safety Action Plan

- Client: U.S. National Water Safety Action Plan
- Information architecture
- Taxonomy
- Search + filtering
- WordPress

The challenge

USNWSAP's mission is to prevent drowning in the U.S. through evidence-informed action. A database of 98 Action Recommendations supports this — making it easy to navigate and implement those recommendations is key to the mission's success.

What we did

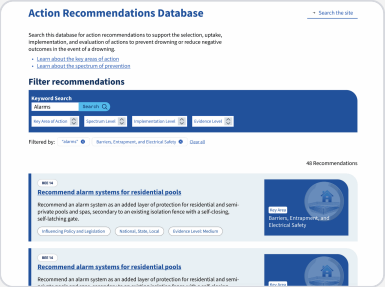
I designed the filter-and-sort system for the recommendations database and wireframed the website. We built a WordPress CMS that integrates the database with the site, so specific recommendations can be pulled into other parts of the site as needed. Because recommendations and taxonomies are easy to edit, the system is future-proof.

Why it matters

Drowning affects people across the U.S. but is preventable. Integrating the database throughout the site made evidence-based recommendations easy to find, interpret, and implement.

4,500+

drowning deaths per year in the U.S. (2020–2022) — the problem we designed against



SECTION 05

Thought leadership

Design gets better when it's shared. Alongside shipping product, I mentor designers, run workshops, and document best practices — helping build the kind of strong, generous design culture Whatnot values.

Talks, trainings, and mentorship

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Training and mentoring

As a product design strategist and senior UX/UI designer, I mentor and train coworkers across disciplines. One example: a company-wide library of 50+ one-page UX/UI/IxD best-practice write-ups I created and maintain — covering interaction design, accessibility, and usability — adopted by 80+ colleagues.

Talks, presentations, and workshops

I speak and present at UX and public-health conferences (UXPA, Health Literacy in Action, Access for All, among others) on Designing for Accessibility, Digital Health Literacy, Inclusive Design, and Numeracy & Data Visualization. I also lead design-thinking workshops and trainings, online and in person.

Health Literacy Online

I'm responsible for most of the UX/UI guidelines in the refreshed *Health Literacy Online* resource — a research-based guide to creating health websites and digital tools that work for a wide range of audiences. It's the kind of shared, documented craft that raises the quality bar for a whole team.

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Thanks!

I'd love to talk about how systems-minded, accessible product design can help Whatnot build the future of live commerce.

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